VON ZAROVICH ESTATE / STATION 3

The Clockwork Observatory

The stars are watching. The clock is moving.

The stairs curl upward into a round room of brass, cold glass, and midnight blue. A painted sky sweeps across the domed ceiling. Constellations glitter overhead, their shapes half-lost among the stars. The air smells of metal polish and long-cold candle smoke.

A huge brass vault door fills the far wall. Four empty pegs sit in a row, numbered one through four, with a crank handle at the center. A small arrow and a bronze inscription catch the light above the mechanism.

On the worktable lie seven loose brass gears. Their teeth make uneven little shadows across the tabletop. Beside them sit an astrolabe and a star chart. Everything looks as though its owner stepped away in the middle of an experiment and never came back.

Then the great wall clock strikes.

Something steps out of its face: an empty suit of armor, suspended around a knot of whirring gears. A pendulum blade swings from one gauntlet. There is no person inside. There is only the ticking.

The phantom turns toward you. The vault stays shut. Tick. Tick. Tick.

What do you do? Talk with your partner. Tell the DM what you want to examine or try. Your character sheet may give you ideas.